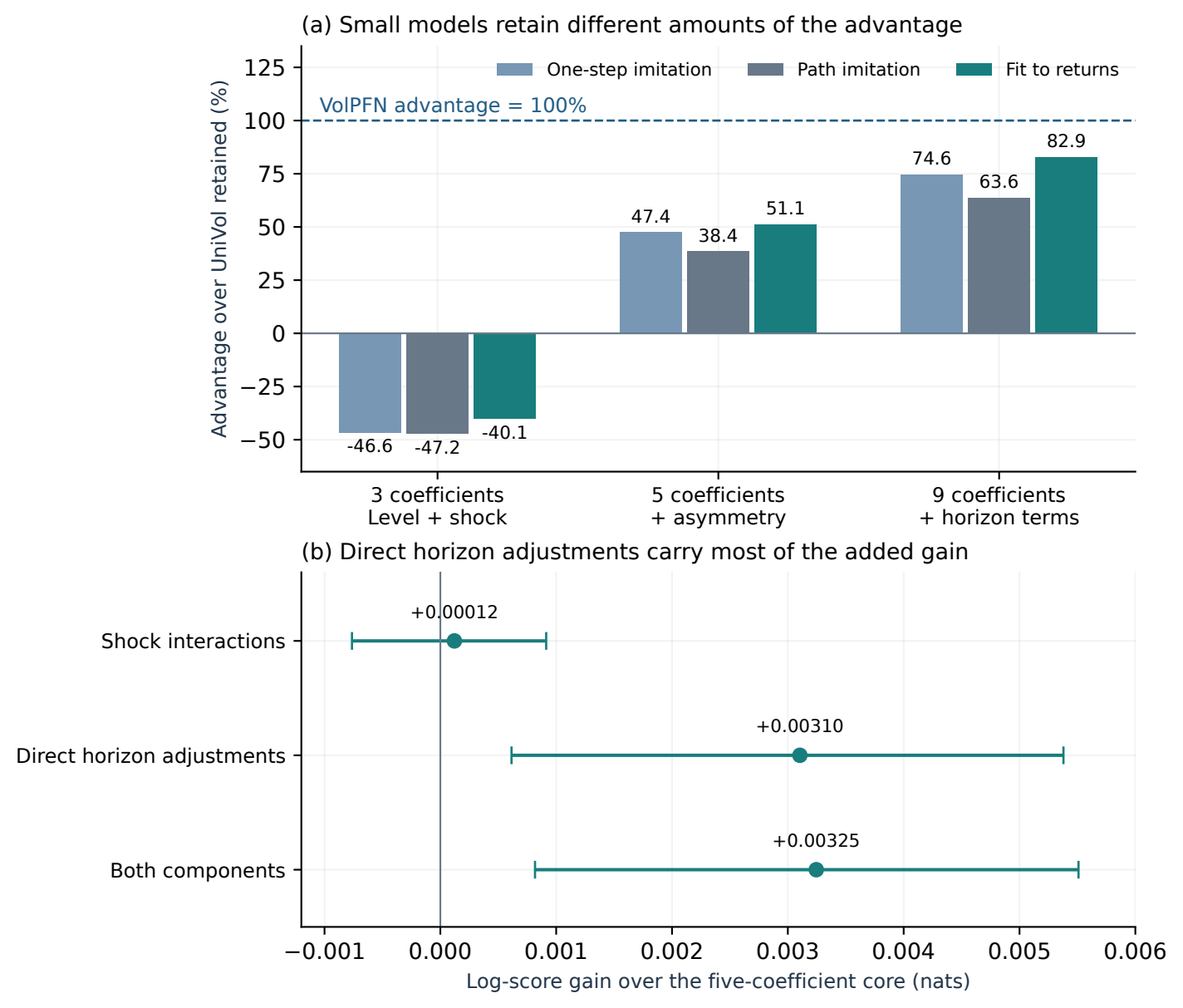
(a) Small models retain different amounts of the advantage
One-step imitation
Path imitation
Fit to returns
VolPFN advantage = 100%
Advantage over UniVol retained (%)
125
100
75
50
25
0
−25
−50
-46.6
-47.2
-40.1
47.4
38.4
51.1
74.6
63.6
82.9
3 coefficients
Level + shock
5 coefficients
+ asymmetry
9 coefficients
+ horizon terms
(b) Direct horizon adjustments carry most of the added gain
Shock interactions
Direct horizon adjustments
Both components
+0.00012
+0.00310
+0.00325
−0.001
0.000
0.001
0.002
0.003
0.004
0.005
0.006
Log-score gain over the five-coefficient core (nats)